EXPERIMENT 09

Exploring AI-Assisted Features and Built-In Analytics (Zia) in Zoho Creator

Dashboard Insights, Conditional Formatting, and Kanban Analytics for the Library Book Issue Request Form

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Aim

To explore the AI-assisted and built-in analytics capabilities of Zoho Creator — powered by Zia, Zoho's AI assistant — by reviewing the dashboard, colour-formatted reports, and Kanban-grouped views of the Library Book Issue Request Form application, and to understand how these features turn raw form data into actionable visual insight without writing custom code.

Objectives

- To review the application dashboard's summary tiles and charts (requests by book category, number of copies and member type).
- To study how colour formatting on report columns makes key fields stand out so records are easy to scan at a glance.
- To study Kanban report views (Member type, Book Category) as a built-in way to group and visualise requests without any scripting.
- To review the All Library Management report as the structured data these analytics are built on.
- To understand Zia's role within Zoho Creator in suggesting chart types, generating dashboard layouts, and surfacing patterns in application data.

Software / Tools Required

- Zoho Creator (web-based low-code application development platform)
- Library Book Issue Request Form application (created on Oct 06, 2026)
- Web browser with an active internet connection
- Zoho account with access to the application in Access/Live mode

Introduction / Theory

Built-In Analytics in Zoho Creator

Zoho Creator ships with analytics components that turn form records into visual summaries without any separate BI tool. A Dashboard page can combine summary tiles, pie and bar charts, and embedded reports in one view; individual reports can use colour formatting to highlight rows, cells or columns; and a Kanban report groups records into columns by a chosen field, giving a board-style view of status, category or member type. All of these read live data directly from the application's forms, so the visuals update automatically as records are added or changed.

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Zia — Zoho's AI Assistant

Zia is the AI layer built into the Zoho ecosystem, including Creator. Within Creator, Zia-driven features assist application builders by suggesting appropriate chart types for a given report, helping auto-generate dashboard layouts from existing forms, and surfacing trends that would otherwise need manual analysis. Rather than requiring the developer to hand-code every chart, Zia-assisted suggestions speed up the process of turning a plain data table into a meaningful summary.

Key Concepts

Concept	Description
Dashboard	A custom page combining summary tiles, charts, and embedded reports into a single, auto-refreshing overview of application data.
Chart Widget	A visual element (pie, bar, donut, etc.) bound to a report that summarises records by a chosen field, such as Book Category or Member Type.
Conditional Formatting	A report-level rule that colours a cell or row automatically based on its value, making important values (e.g. a member type or request status) stand out without manual review.
Kanban Report	A board-style report that groups records into columns by a selected field (e.g. Member Type, Book Category), letting staff scan records visually.
Zia Insights	AI-assisted suggestions within Zoho Creator that recommend chart types, help assemble dashboard layouts, and highlight patterns in the underlying data.

Application Specifications

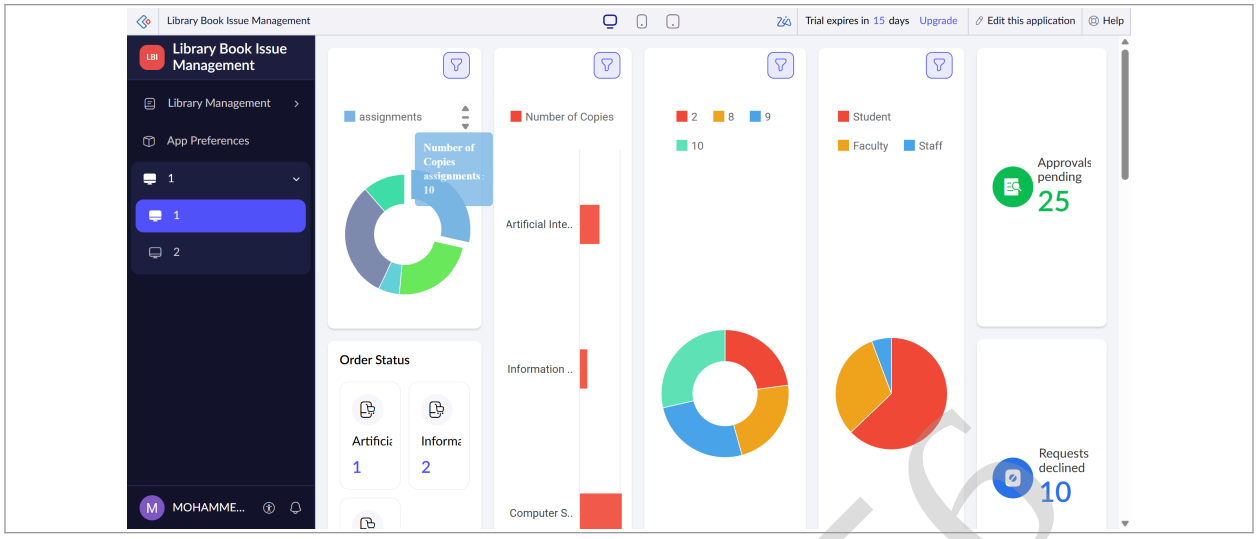
Parameter	Detail
Application Name	Library Book Issue Request Form
Primary Forms	library management form (book issue requests)
Dashboard Elements	Charts by book category, number of copies and member type; Approvals pending and Requests declined summary tiles
Formatted Reports	All Library Management (colour applied to the Name, roll number and Member type columns)
Kanban Reports	Book_Issue_Request_Report grouped by Member type (Student, Faculty, Staff) and by Book Category
Standard Data Report	All Library Management — Name, roll number, Member type, Email, Contact number, Hostel/Residential address

Procedure

1. Open the application dashboard — Opening the Library Book Issue Request Form application loads its Dashboard, which summarises the book issue request data into tiles and charts.

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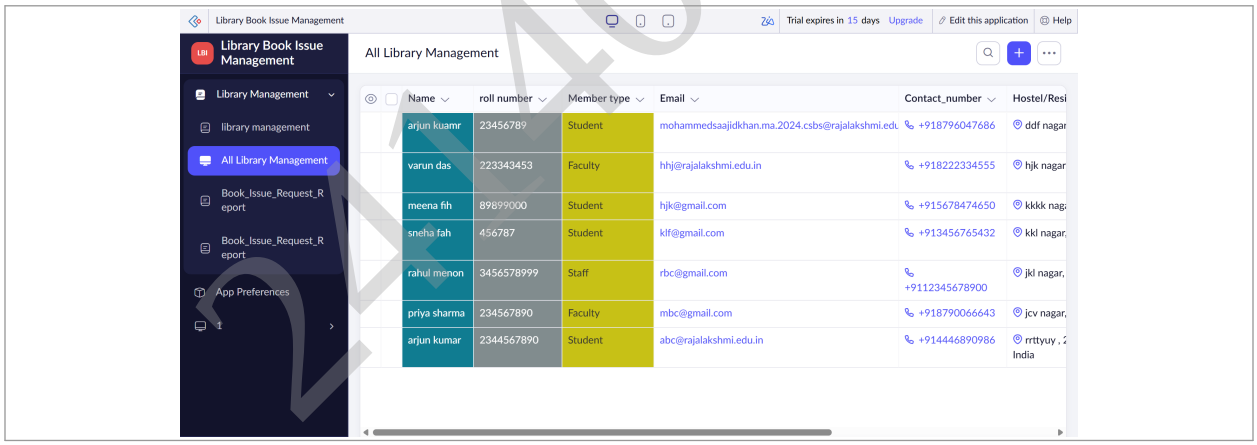
Figure 9.1: Dashboard — Summary Tiles and Charts



The dashboard shows donut and pie charts and a bar chart summarising requests by book category, number of copies and member type, along with the Approvals pending (25) and Requests declined (10) summary tiles.

2. Apply colour formatting to the request report — The All Library Management report was opened in the report builder and colour was applied to its columns. Zia was first asked to apply the colour rules, but it replied that formatting on this field type had to be set up manually in the report builder, so the colours were applied there.

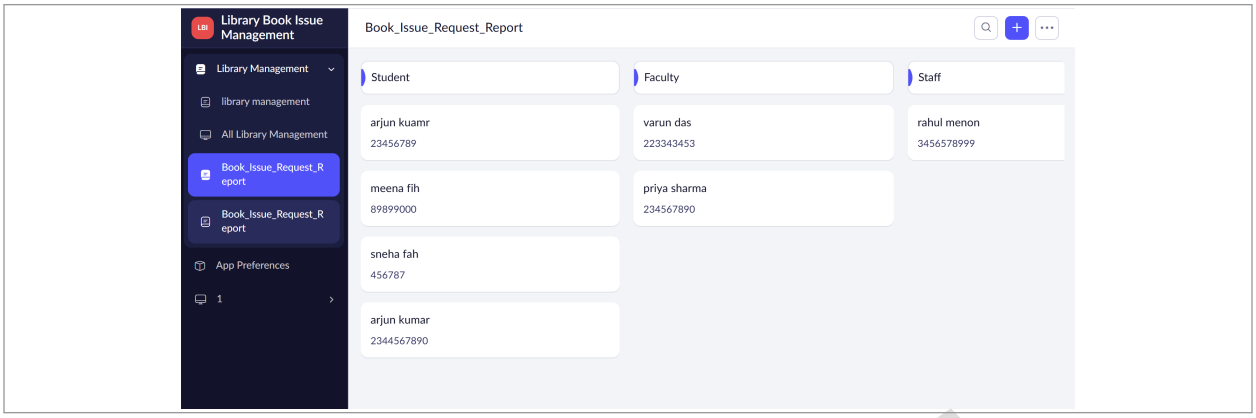
Figure 9.2: All Library Management — Colour Formatting on Report Columns



The Name column is shaded teal, roll number grey and Member type yellow, so the key columns stand out and a reviewer can scan the whole report quickly instead of reading every cell.

3. Switch to the Member type Kanban view — A Kanban report was opened, grouping the book issue requests into columns by their Member type field.

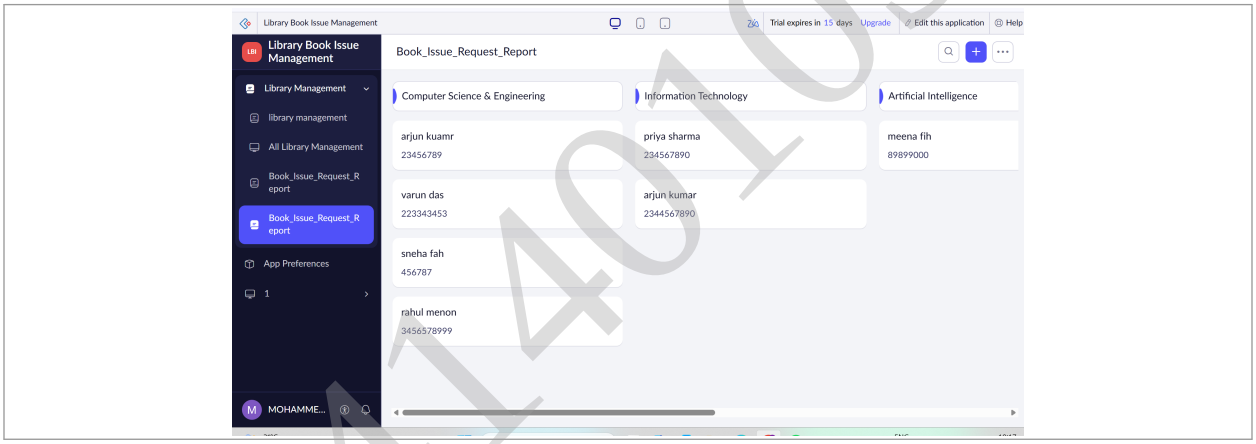
Figure 9.3: Book_Issue_Request_Report — Kanban Grouped by Member Type



The board shows three columns (Student, Faculty, Staff) with each request rendered as a card showing the member's name and number, so staff can see at a glance who is requesting books.

4. Switch to the Book Category Kanban view — A second Kanban report was opened, grouping the same requests by Book Category.

Figure 9.4: Book_Issue_Request_Report — Kanban Grouped by Book Category

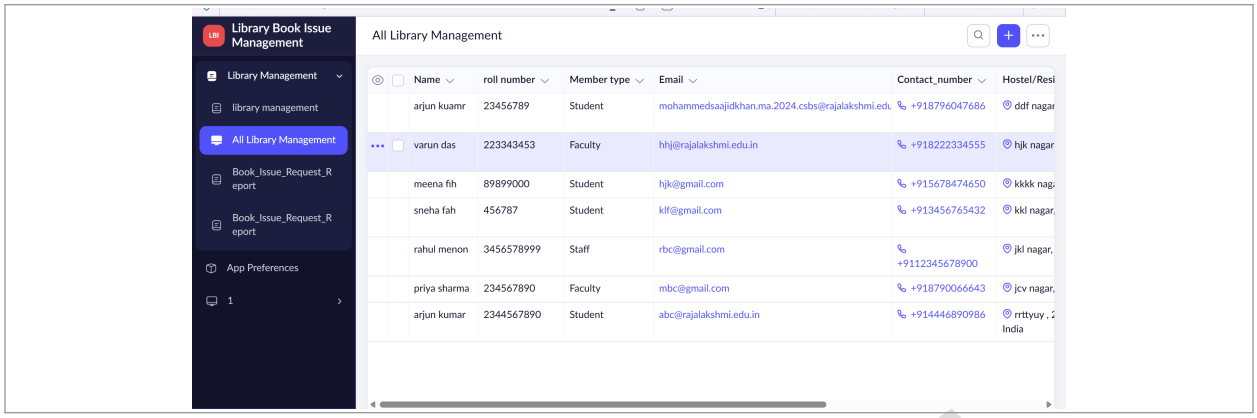


Request cards are grouped into columns such as Computer Science & Engineering, Information Technology and Artificial Intelligence, showing library staff which section needs to prepare books.

5. Review the underlying report data — The All Library Management report was opened in its standard view to confirm the structured request data that the dashboard, formatting and Kanban views draw on.

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Figure 9.5: All Library Management — Structured Request Data



Seven requests are listed with their Name, roll number, Member type, Email, Contact number and Hostel/Residential address, forming the clean data that the dashboard and Kanban views summarise.

Result

- The Library Book Issue Request Form dashboard was reviewed, confirming that it summarises book issue requests into live tiles and charts.
- Colour formatting was applied to the All Library Management report, making the Name, roll number and Member type columns stand out.
- Zia was asked to apply the formatting and replied that it had to be configured manually in the report builder.
- Two Kanban report views, grouped by Member type and by Book Category, were reviewed, confirming that requests can be grouped and browsed visually by any chosen field.
- The All Library Management report was reviewed as the structured data underlying these analytics.

Conclusion

The experiment demonstrated how Zoho Creator's built-in analytics and Zia-assisted features convert plain book issue request records into decision-ready visuals with no custom charting code. The dashboard's tiles and charts give an instant overview of volume and distribution, colour formatting makes key columns easy to scan, and Kanban reports let library staff browse the same data as a visual board grouped by member type or book category. Zia supports this by suggesting charts and layouts, although some formatting still has to be configured manually in the report builder. Together these features show that low-code analytics in Zoho Creator is a natural extension of the structured forms and reports already built in earlier experiments.

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